



MARKETING LABS · IMPACT & RESEARCH

Theory of Change Mapper

Make the route from resources to change visible.

Theory of Change Mapper: build a connected pathway from inputs and activities to outputs, outcomes, impact, assumptions and evidence.

Includes: framework reference · guidance by Pathway stage · printable worksheet

Theory of Change Mapper: reference

VISUAL PROGRAMME-DESIGN PROTOTYPE

Build a connected pathway from inputs and activities to outputs, near-term outcomes, longer-term outcomes and intended impact. Use assumptions, risks and evidence signals to turn an ambitious funding narrative into a more testable, evaluable programme design.

A theory of change is a hypothesis, not a guarantee. It should state what needs to be true, who needs to be involved, what could disrupt the pathway and how progress will be observed and adapted over time.

Connected pathway

A visual hypothesis of how programme activity could contribute to intended outcomes and impact.

Inputs

Activities

Outputs

Outcomes

Impact

Contribution pathway

Assumption or dependency

INPUTS ACTIVITIES OUTPUTS OUTCOMES IMPACT INPUT Research funding, EO data and local partnerships
Funding, satellite-derived heat indicators, geographic data, research expertise and ASSUMPTION NOTED ACTIVITY
Neighbourhood climate evidence workshops Bring satellite-derived heat evidence together with local knowledge, lived experience and ASSUMPTION NOTED OUTPUT Shared heat-risk maps and action briefs Produce accessible maps, plain-language explainers and locally relevant decision ASSUMPTION NOTED OUTCOME Improved local decision capability Partners have a stronger evidence base and shared language for considering heat, ASSUMPTION NOTED IMPACT More equitable heat-resilience planning The programme contributes to better-informed and more inclusive approaches to reducing ASSUMPTION NOTED Cooler neighbourhoods: evidence, engagement and green infrastructure

PATHWAY COMPLETENESS

All five stages are represented. Check whether each connection is plausible, specific and proportionate to the proposed scale.

EVIDENCE PLANNING

5 of 5 nodes have an evidence indicator. Add measures for both delivery and meaningful changes, not only outputs or reach.

ASSUMPTION CHECK

5 of 5 nodes include an explicit assumption. Review power, feasibility, context and dependencies at each link.

Funding-bid reviewer prompts

- ? What specific problem or opportunity is the programme trying to change, and for whom?
- ? Does every output have a credible route to an outcome, rather than assuming that delivery alone creates change?
- ? Which stakeholders are involved in interpreting needs, designing activities and judging whether change is meaningful?

- ? What assumptions, external conditions, risks or power dynamics could disrupt the pathway?
- ? How will you monitor delivery, learn during implementation and adapt if expected outcomes do not emerge?
- ? Which changes are realistically measurable during the funding period, and which are longer-term intended contributions?

Guidance by Pathway stage

Input

Activity

Output

Outcome

Impact

Theory of Change Mapper: your canvas

Print this page or fill it in by hand. The interactive lab asks the same questions.

Programme or bid title

For example: Healthier places through local climate evidence

Pathway stage

☐ Input ☐ Activity ☐ Output ☐ Outcome ☐ Impact

Indicative timeframe

☐ 0–6 months ☐ 6–12 months ☐ 1–2 years ☐ 2–5 years ☐ 5+ years

Node title

For example: Co-designed evidence workshops

What happens or changes?

Be specific about the resource, action, deliverable, change or longer-term benefit.

Evidence or indicator

How would you know this happened or changed?

Critical assumption or dependency

What must be true for this step to lead to the next?

Connect from

Link this node to a preceding node. The connector represents a hypothesis, not proof of causation.

- ☐ Start a new pathway ☐ Input: Research funding, EO data and local partnerships
- ☐ Activity: Neighbourhood climate evidence workshops ☐ Output: Shared heat-risk maps and action briefs
- ☐ Outcome: Improved local decision capability ☐ Impact: More equitable heat-resilience planning
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Planning aid, not advice. Test assumptions with evidence and consider privacy, accessibility, fairness and sustainability before acting.